unless he was ready to change his political loyalties. The Nazim, who at the time was with the PML (Q), 'blamed politics, stating that unless he was willing to switch parties. . .neither the Pakistan Muslim League–Nawaz provincial nor the Pakistan Peoples Party federal governments would take his requests seriously' (*Dawn*, 2011).

NEED FOR A COUNTER-TERRORISM STRATEGY

A number of countries that faced terrorism formulated counter-terrorism strategies and successfully controlled, annihilated and eliminated the terrorist groups and their activities. A few that can be cited in this regard are: Britain-IRA, France-GIA, Venezuela-The FALN-FLN, Columbia-FARC, Turkey-PKK, Russia-Chechnya, India-Khalistan, Sri Lanka-LTTE, Japan-Aum Shinrikyo and Italy-Red Brigades (Koch, 2007). Pakistan could learn lesson from these countries.

The most relevant case study could be the UK's counter-terrorism strategy, CONTEST, which aimed at reducing the risk to the UK and its interests overseas from international terrorism.[2] It was formulated in 2003 and was revised in 2009, named as CONTEST II.

It was organised in four work streams: pursue, prevent, protect and prepare.[3] It clearly demarcated the responsibilities of various government and non-government departments, which included police, MI-6, MI-5, Health Protection Agency, UK Border Agency, Regional and Local Government, Airport Operators, Shopping Centre Management, Private Security Companies, Community and Sector Interest Groups and so on.

As compared to it, Pakistan has no officially articulated CT strategy. At one point in time, a three **Ds** slogan, **Development, Dialogue** and **Deterrence**, was presented, pretended and portrayed as a strategy.[4] In fact, it was a strategy outline for counter-insurgency, which was being pursued by the army in Waziristan and Swat areas. It had nothing to do with countering terrorism in urban centres. Even this slogan had never been debated in the parliament and the government did not bother to officially formulate and formally articulate a strategy. Political analyst Prof. As Moonis Ahmar stated, 'There is no coherent policy to counter terrorism' (*Dawn*, 2011). A number of senior officers of police, IB and ISI were interviewed, who had a consensus that there was no written, approved and comprehensive CT strategy of Pakistan. However, a plan